Patient Diabetes Care & Nutrition Guide

Understanding Diabetes

Diabetes is a chronic condition affecting how the body turns food into energy. Type 1 diabetes is an autoimmune condition where the body stops producing insulin. Type 2 diabetes occurs when the body becomes resistant to insulin and struggles to produce enough.

Blood Sugar Monitoring

Routinely check blood glucose levels using a glucometer or continuous glucose monitor (CGM). Target pre-meal glucose ranges should be 80-130 mg/dL, and post-meal (1-2 hours after) should be below 180 mg/dL. Keep records of your levels for your endocrinologist.

Nutrition Guidelines

Focus on complex carbohydrates (whole grains, oats) rather than simple sugars. Monitor portion sizes, limit sugary beverages, and fill half your plate with non-starchy vegetables (spinach, broccoli). Fiber helps slow sugar absorption and stabilizes levels.

Insulin Storage & Use

Keep unopened insulin in the refrigerator. Open vials or pens can be kept at room temperature but must be discarded after 28 days. Avoid extreme temperatures (direct sunlight or freezing) as it ruins the effectiveness.